Loner: Norse Saga

Version: 3

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Loner: Norse Saga

INTRODUCTION

What is Loner: Norse Saga?

Loner: Norse Saga is a solo tabletop RPG set in the Viking Age—a time when honor was worth more than gold, blood feuds could last generations, and a warrior's deeds were immortalized in saga or forgotten in shame.

This minimalist Solo Role Playing Game is designed to tell **gritty, honor-driven sagas** of exploration, raiding, settlement, and blood vengeance. You play a single protagonist whose reputation is built through deeds and whose fate is shaped by the consequences of those actions.

Design Principles:

1. **Portable** – All you need is four six-sided dice, paper, and your imagination. No other materials required.
2. **Rules-Light** – The Oracle mechanic is the only resolution system. Easy to learn, quick to resolve.
3. **Tag-Based** – Your hero is defined by **evocative descriptors**, not numbers. A *Shield-Wall Veteran* is different from a *Silver-Tongued Skald* in every meaningful way.

With a focus on **laconic storytelling and dramatic consequences**, *Loner: Norse Saga* throws you into the harsh

realities of the Viking Age. Your character will be defined by **honor, reputation, and the weight of oaths**—breaking your word can be worse than death.

What is a Role-Playing Game?

A role-playing game is a storytelling experience where you assume the role of a character and make decisions that shape their journey. In most RPGs, a game master controls the world. In *Loner: Norse Saga*, **you are both player and world—the Oracle guides what happens next**.

What is a Solo RPG?

In a solo RPG, a single player takes on the role of a protagonist while managing the broader game world through oracle mechanics and random tables. Unlike a gamebook with predetermined branches, a solo RPG creates **emergent narrative**—anything can be attempted, and the outcome is never locked in advance.

Through the interaction of your character, the Oracle's voice, and the roll of the dice, your story builds something no one could have predicted at the start. Will you die gloriously in battle, or live long enough to see your grandchildren inherit your feuds?

Safety Tools

You play alone, in complete control. If a scene becomes uncomfortable—whether through violence, betrayal, or loss—you can pause, reframe, or step away. *There is no shame in choosing your own comfort*. Your story, your rules.

Minimum Requirements

To play *Loner: Norse Saga* you will need:

- **4 six-sided dice** in two colors (two pairs)

- **Paper and a pencil** or pen
- **A character sheet** (provided in the appendix or use an index card)
- **Optional: A notebook** to track blood feuds, reputation, and ongoing sagas

THE VIKING AGE

The world of *Loner: Norse Saga* is **historical, not mythological**—though the supernatural exists at the edges, rare and dangerous. This is the age of exploration, settlement, and saga-worthy deeds.

The World

Scandinavia sprawls across the north—fjords cutting deep into mountains, forests thick with game, and farms clinging to rocky soil. The sea is both highway and graveyard. Winter kills the unprepared. Summer brings raiding season.

- **Norway**: Fractured kingdoms, rival jarls, mountain valleys where families hold ancient land rights
- **Denmark**: Richer farmland, more centralized power, gateway to the Frankish kingdoms
- **Sweden**: Trading empires reaching east to Byzantium, vast forests, Uppsala's temple
- **Iceland**: New land, free from kings, where exiles and adventurers forge new laws at the Thing
- **Beyond**: Britain, Ireland, Francia, the Mediterranean, even distant Vinland across the western ocean

The sea connects everything. A longship can carry you to wealth, death, or a new life. Navigation is by sun, stars, and the flight of ravens. Storms drown entire crews. Sea-serpents may be real—or just stories to frighten children.

The Gods & the Otherworldly

The Æsir and Vanir are real to your people—Odin All-Father, Thor Thunder-Wielder, Freyja Lady of Love and War. They receive sacrifices at blóts, witness oaths, and are invoked before battle. But **the gods do not walk among mortals** in this age. They act through omens, dreams, and the völvas who speak their will.

Priests (*goðar*) maintain temples and lead sacrifices. Völvas (seeresses) practice *seidr* magic, falling into trance to speak prophecy or curse enemies. These things are **accepted as real**, not questioned.

The otherworldly exists alongside the ordinary:

- **Draugr** rise from burial mounds to guard their treasure and terrorize the living
- **Landvættir** (land spirits) protect specific places and must be respected
- **Trolls** dwell in mountains and forests, hostile to humans
- **Huldufólk** (hidden folk) live in rocks and hills, dangerous to offend
- **Níðar** (the dead) can be raised by seidr, though it is grim work
- **Hamramr** (shape-shifters) walk in animal form while their bodies sleep
- **Fylgjur** (fetch-spirits) appear as omens of death

The sagas speak of these things **as matter of fact**. When Grettir fights a draugr, the saga does not marvel—it simply records what happened. When a völva prophesies, people listen or ignore her at their peril. The otherworldly is part of life, neither common nor impossible.

This is not Ragnarök. The world is not ending. The gods are distant. But the boundary between the living and the

dead, between human and other, is thinner than Christians believe.

Playable Themes

- **Honor & Reputation**: Your worth is measured in others' eyes. Shame is worse than death.
- **Blood Feuds**: When kin is killed, vengeance is obligation. But vengeance breeds counter-vengeance.
- **Exploration & Settlement**: New lands offer freedom from old enemies—and new dangers.
- **Oaths & Betrayal**: Your word binds you. Breaking it destroys your name.
- **Raiding & Plunder**: Summer voyages to foreign shores. Glory, wealth, and enemies.
- **Thing Assemblies**: Law-speaking, political maneuvering, public judgment.
- **Legacy & Saga**: Will skalds remember your name, or will you die forgotten?

Timeline

793 CE - Lindisfarne: The age begins. Norwegian raiders strike the monastery at Lindisfarne, England. The world learns to fear the Northmen.

800-850 CE: Raiding intensifies across Britain, Ireland, and Francia. Monasteries burn. Coastal towns fortify. Kings pay tribute or fight back.

860 CE - Iceland Discovered: Norwegian explorers find the uninhabited island. Within decades, settlers flee Norway's tyranny to forge a new society.

865 CE - The Great Heathen Army: Massive Viking force invades England. The Danelaw is established. Viking kingdoms rule much of Britain.

930 CE - The Althing: Iceland establishes its assembly at Thingvellir—the world's oldest surviving parliament. Law without kings.

982 CE - Greenland Settled: Erik the Red, exiled from Iceland for murder, discovers and colonizes Greenland.

1000 CE - Christianity Spreads: Iceland converts (officially) to Christianity. The old gods retreat, but slowly.

1000 CE - Vinland: Leif Erikson reaches North America, five centuries before Columbus.

1066 CE - Stamford Bridge: King Harald Hardrada of Norway invades England. He is killed in battle. Three weeks later, William the Conqueror lands at Hastings. The Viking Age ends.

Your saga takes place somewhere in these three centuries. Choose your era. The world is different at each point.

CHARACTERS: FORGED IN HONOR

In *Loner: Norse Saga*, your **protagonist is defined by deeds, oaths, and reputation**.

Everything is a Character

Non-Playing Characters, foes, rival clans, longships, and even ancestral swords that play a meaningful role in your story are **described as characters** using the same descriptive framework. A **rival jarl**, a **famous blade**, and a **blood-cursed family** all have Concepts, Skills, Frailties, and Goals.

Protagonist Traits

Your hero is described by these traits:

- **Name**: An authentic Old Norse name (use the naming tables provided)
- **Origin**: One of six archetypes that defines your role in Viking society
- **Skills** (x2): Specialized abilities tied to your origin—specific, evocative, and narratively meaningful
- **Frailty**: A weakness, flaw, or obligation that complicates your path
- **Gear** (x2): Meaningful equipment tied to your identity and status
- **Honor**: Your reputation, reflected in tags earned through play (e.g., "Oath-Keeper," "Generous Host," "Kinslayer")
- **Goal**: What drives your saga forward
- **Motive**: Why this goal matters to you
- **Nemesis** (optional initially): Emerges during play—rival jarls, blood feuds, past betrayals
- **Luck**: Your ability to cheat fate in battle. Starts at 6, applies only in Conflicts, resets after each conflict ends.
- **Hamingja**: Family spiritual power. Starts at 3, spent to reroll Oracle or declare fortunate coincidence.

These **traits are described by tags**—qualitative descriptors, never numbers. You are not "Strong +2." You are *Bear-Strong* or *Shield-Splitter*. Tags define everything in the game world—characters, locations, seasons, and the turning of fate.

Character Death & Legacy

Vikings die. Often violently. When your protagonist falls:

1. **Create their legacy**: What do skalds say about them? What byname did they earn?

2. **Pass the torch**: Play as their kinsman, inheriting unfinished blood feuds and family honor (or shame)
3. **Carry forward**: Hamingja (spiritual power) can pass to descendants

Death is not failure. **A good death, well-remembered, is victory.**

Saga Structure

Think of your game as an **Icelandic saga**:

- **Laconic tone**: Understatement is power. "That was well struck," not "He screamed in agony!"
- **Dramatic irony**: Prophecies that come true despite efforts to avoid them
- **Legal drama**: Thing assemblies, lawsuits, clever arguments
- **Blood feuds**: Actions have consequences across generations
- **Witness culture**: Deeds without witnesses don't build reputation

Your Oracle becomes the saga's narrator—impartial, matter-of-fact, recording what happened.

CHARACTER CREATION: SIX ORIGINS

Choose (or roll 1d6) one of six **Viking origins**. Each origin defines your role in society and comes with dedicated tables for Skills, Frailties, and Gear.

ORIGIN 1: HERSIR (War Leader)

Commander of warriors, oath-bound to your jarl, leader in battle and raid.

You are the jarl's right hand—commanding his warband, leading raids, enforcing his will. Your word carries weight.

Your courage inspires. Your death would be mourned in saga.

Skills (roll 1d6 twice, or pick 2):

D6	Hersir Skills
1	Shield-Wall Tactics
2	Battle Command
3	Weapon Master
4	Ship Tactics
5	Inspire Courage
6	Read the Field

Frailties (roll 1d6, or pick 1):

D6	Hersir Frailties
1	Oath-Bound to Jarl
2	Battle-Scarred
3	Cannot Refuse Challenge
4	Burden of Command
5	Haunted by Fallen
6	Rival for Position

Gear (roll 1d6 twice, or pick 2):

D6	Hersir Gear
1	Named Sword
2	Chainmail Byrnie
3	War Horn
4	Battle Banner
5	Jarl's Gift-Ring

D6	Hersir Gear
6	Iron Helm

ORIGIN 2: SKALD (Saga Poet)

Memory-keeper, reputation-maker, wielder of words that immortalize or destroy.

You remember. Every deed, every name, every slight. You speak saga at feasts, compose praise or cutting verse, and decide whose name lives beyond death. Kings fear your words as much as swords.

Skills (roll 1d6 twice, or pick 2):

D6	Skald Skills
1	Flyting (Verbal Combat)
2	Perfect Memory
3	Saga-Telling
4	Rune-Reading
5	Keen Observer
6	Silver-Tongued

Frailties (roll 1d6, or pick 1):

D6	Skald Frailties
1	Cannot Tell Lies
2	Compelled to Witness
3	Words Bring Trouble
4	Frail in Battle
5	Cursed by Subject
6	Rival Skald

Gear (roll 1d6 twice, or pick 2):

D6	Skald Gear
1	Harp
2	Saga-Scroll
3	Rune-Carved Staff
4	Silver Arm-Ring
5	Fine Cloak
6	Ink & Vellum

ORIGIN 3: VÖLVA (Seeress)

Walker between worlds, fate-reader, speaker of prophecy, feared and respected.

You practice seidr magic, fall into trance, speak with the dead. Your prophecies shape the fates of jarls and thralls alike. Some call you witch. Others call you wise. None dare ignore you.

Skills (roll 1d6 twice, or pick 2):

D6	Völva Skills
1	Seidr Magic
2	Fate-Reading
3	Spirit-Sight
4	Herb-Lore
5	Weather-Reading
6	Curse-Weaving

Frailties (roll 1d6, or pick 1):

D6	Völva Frailties
1	Marked by Spirits
2	Iron-Weak
3	Prophetic Burden
4	Socially Isolated
5	Visions Unmake Mind
6	Feared, Not Loved

Gear (roll 1d6 twice, or pick 2):

D6	Völva Gear
1	Seidr Staff
2	Divination Bones
3	Spirit Cloak
4	Ritual Herbs
5	Sacred Distalf
6	Trance-Inducing Brew

ORIGIN 4: VÍKINGR (Raider)

Sea-wolf, plunderer, adventurer seeking fame and fortune on foreign shores.

You are what the Christians fear—a professional raider, swift and deadly. Summer means voyage. Monastery gold, Frankish silver, Irish cattle. You take what you can carry and burn the rest.

Skills (roll 1d6 twice, or pick 2):

D6	Víkingr Skills
1	Seafaring

D6	Víkingr Skills
2	Axe-Fighting
3	Climbing & Scaling
4	Navigation
5	Quick Escape
6	Plunder Sense

Frailties (roll 1d6, or pick 1):

D6	Víkingr Frailties
1	Greedy
2	Outlawed Abroad
3	Sea-Sick
4	Wanted in Many Lands
5	Reckless
6	No Land, No Home

Gear (roll 1d6 twice, or pick 2):

D6	Víkingr Gear
1	Bearded Axe
2	Longship Share
3	Rope & Grappling Hook
4	Plunder Sack
5	Weatherproof Cloak
6	Foreign Coins

ORIGIN 5: GOÐI (Chieftain-Priest)

Leader of the Thing, lawkeeper, mediator between gods and community.

You are pillar and arbiter. You lead blót sacrifices, speak law at the Thing, settle disputes, and bind oaths. Your word shapes what is lawful. Your favor is power.

Skills (roll 1d6 twice, or pick 2):

D6	Goði Skills
1	Law-Speaking
2	Thing-Mastery
3	Judgment
4	Blót Rituals
5	Negotiation
6	Authority

Frailties (roll 1d6, or pick 1):

D6	Goði Frailties
1	Bound by Tradition
2	Political Enemies
3	Must Remain Neutral
4	Family Feuds
5	Challenged Authority
6	Weight of Responsibility

Gear (roll 1d6 twice, or pick 2):

D6	Goði Gear
1	Arm-Ring of Authority
2	Law-Stone
3	Ritual Implements
4	Fine Cloak

D6	Goði Gear
5	Oath-Ring
6	Temple Key

ORIGIN 6: BERSERKR (Shapeshifter Warrior)

Bear-skin wearer, fury-channeler, elite warrior cursed with uncontrollable rage.

You are both hero and monster. In battle, the bear-fury takes you—superhuman strength, immunity to pain, unstoppable violence. Afterward, you remember little. Jarls hire you. Warriors fear you. Families avoid you.

Skills (roll 1d6 twice, or pick 2):

D6	Berserkr Skills
1	Battle Fury
2	Pain Immunity
3	Fear-Inspiring
4	Bear Strength
5	Hamramr (Shape-Shift)
6	Relentless

Frailties (roll 1d6, or pick 1):

D6	Berserkr Frailties
1	Uncontrollable Rage
2	Cannot Wear Armor
3	Socially Feared
4	Rage Exhaustion
5	Kills Indiscriminately

D6	Berserkr Frailties
6	Cursed Bloodline

Gear (roll 1d6 twice, or pick 2):

D6	Berserkr Gear
1	Bear/Wolf Pelt
2	Massive Weapon
3	Trophy Necklace
4	War Paint
5	Ritual Mushrooms
6	Iron Chains (for restraint)

VIKING NAMES

Use these tables to generate authentic Old Norse names for your protagonist and NPCs. Roll 2d6 (one for row, one for column) or choose.

Female Names

	1	2	3	4	5	6
1	Astrid	Brynja	Dagny	Eira	Freydis	Gudrun
2	Helga	Ingrid	Jorunn	Kari	Liv	Margret
3	Nanna	Oda	Ragn-hild	Sigrid	Thora	Unn
4	Vigdis	Yngvild	Asa	Bothild	Dalla	Estra
5	Geira	Halla	Inga	Joreid	Katla	Lagertha
6	Oddny	Ragna	Signy	Thyra	Ulfhild	Val-gerda

Male Names

	1	2	3	4	5	6
1	Alf	Bjorn	Einar	Erik	Finn	Gunnar
2	Halfdan	Harald	Ivar	Knut	Leif	Magnus
3	Njal	Olaf	Ragnar	Sigurd	Thorvald	Ulf
4	Vidar	Yngvar	Asbjorn	Bard	Egil	Floki
5	Grimr	Hakon	Ingolf	Jorund	Ketil	Ljot
6	Orm	Rollo	Skeggi	Thorfinn	Ulfar	Vali

Patronymics & Matronymics

Old Norse names follow the pattern: [Given Name] + [Father's/Mother's Name] + son/dottir

	1	2	3	4	5	6
1	Eriksson	Bjornsson	Haraldsson	Ragnarsson	Thorsson	Ulfsson
2	Gunnarsson	Sigurdsson	Olafsson	Knutsson	Leifsson	Einarsson
3	Eriksdottir	Bjornsdottir	Haraldsdottir	Ragnarsdottir	Thorsdottir	Ulfsdottir
4	Gunnarsdottir	Sigurdsdottir	Olafsdottir	Knutsdottir	Leifsdottir	Einarsdottir

	1	2	3	4	5	6
5	Hakon-sson	Ingolf-sson	Ketils-son	Njáls-son	Val-gards-son	Yng-vars-son
6	Hakons-dottir	In-golfs-dottir	Ketils-dottir	Njáls-dottir	Val-gards-dottir	Yng-vars-dottir

Bynames

Vikings earned descriptive bynames based on deeds, appearance, or character. These become part of your reputation.

	1	2	3	4	5	6
1	the Bold	Blood-axe	Blue-tooth	Fair-Hair	Iron-Side	the Red
2	Black-beard	the Un-lucky	Silvertongue	Snake-in-the-Eye	the Stout	the Grim
3	the Strong	the Wise	the Swift	the Tall	the Lean	the Fair
4	Flat-Nose	Hard-Ruler	the Deep-Minded	the Pea-cock	the Silent	the Shrewd
5	the Proud	the Gen-erous	the Cruel	the Pale	the Dark	the Fierce
6	Wolf-Coat	Bear-Slayer	Ship-Breaker	Storm-Rider	Skull-Split-ter	the Rest-less

RULES: THE ORACLE'S VOICE

Loner: Norse Saga uses the Oracle to resolve uncertainty. The Oracle is neutral—it records what happens, like a saga narrator.

Keep The Action In Motion

A game in *[Title]* is a succession of scenes. A scene is a unit of time in which a certain action takes place in pursuit of a certain short-term goal.

In *[Title]* at each scene:

1. **Identify what you expect from the scene**. Compared to traits, goal, and motivation determine the Protagonist's action. What might be the reaction of the game world?
2. **Test your expectations**. When you are uncertain (or over-confident) about the reaction to your actions, ask the Oracle a closed question (answer is Yes or No), considering the tags involved to determine if there is an Advantage or Disadvantage.
3. **Interpret the result**. Is the Oracle's answer in line with your expectations? If not, in the context in which the scene takes place, how should an answer that subverts them be considered?

This sequence will come to you naturally after some practice. Use it as a guideline the first few times.

Consulting the Oracle

When you need to test your expectations you'll ask the Oracle a closed question.

You'll need 2d6 in one color (**Chance Dice**), and 2d6 in another (**Risk Dice**).

To resolve a closed question, roll one **Chance Die** and one **Risk Die**:

- If the Chance Die is highest, the answer is **Yes**.
- If the Risk Die is highest, the answer is **No**.
- If both are low (3 or less), add a **but...**.
- If both are high (4 or more), add an **and...**.
- If both are equal, the answer is **Yes, but...**. Add a point to the **Twist Counter**.

Dice Value	Chance Die > Risk Die	Risk Die > Chance Die
Both <= 3	Yes, but...	No, but...
Both >= 4	Yes, and...	No, and...
Mismatched	Yes	No
Equal	Yes, but... Add 1 to the Twist Counter	

Advantage and Disadvantage

If circumstances or positive tags grant an advantage, add a **Chance Die** to the roll. Otherwise, when hindrances or negative tag cause a disadvantage, add a **Risk Die**. In both cases keep only the higher die of the added type when you check the roll.

Consider tags **intuitively and not quantitatively**, using the context of the situation at play. It is important to keep the flow of play fast and not accounting for advantages and disadvantages numerically!

Twist Counter

The Twist Counter is a measure of the rising tension in the narrative. At the beginning is set to 0. Every time a double

throw (dice are equal) happens, add 1 to the Counter. If the Counter is below three, consider the answer as "**Yes, but...**". Otherwise a **Twist** happens and resets the Counter.

Roll 2d6 and consult the following Twist Table to determine what kind of twist happens.

D6	Subject	Action
1	A Rival	Appears / Acts
2	The Hero	Triggers Obligation
3	A Völva	Speaks Prophecy
4	Blood Feud	Escalates
5	The Weather	Turns Deadly
6	An Oath	Is Tested

CONFLICTS

A *Conflict* is any situation in which opponents clash, attacking, defending, or wearing each other down in order to win. This applies both in a practical and metaphorical sense.

So, a Conflict is not only limited to combat (or fighting) in the strict sense but also to competitive situations (such as contests, duels, verbal confrontations, etc.) in which two or more characters (including vehicles, of course!) compete.

Conflicts can be resolved in different ways depending on preferences and context:

1. Ask a single closed question. The Oracle's answer determines the outcome of the conflict.
2. Ask a series of closed questions to resolve current single actions.
3. Use the rules of Harm & Luck below.

Note that the Twist Counter **does not apply** to Harm & Luck. Instead, it is used regularly if the Conflict is handled with closed questions.

If the conflict is resolved by applying damage to the Luck trait, roll the dice to determine whether the protagonist causes damage to the opponent or suffers damage due to counterattack or failed defense. The rolls are player facing only.

The damage reduces the Luck of the target, whether protagonist or NPC. When the Luck runs out, the character has lost the conflict.

The final outcome depends on the context. Do you get caught? Are you seriously injured? You may even die if that fits the narrative.

Answer	Do you get what you want?	Harm
Yes, and...	You get what you want, and something else.	Cause 3
Yes...	You get what you want.	Cause 2
Yes, but...	You get what you want, but at a cost.	Cause 1
No, but...	You don't get what you want, but it's not a total loss.	Take 1
No...	You don't get what you were after.	Take 2
No, and...	You don't get what you want, and things get worse.	Take 3

Luck resets to 6 after each Conflict ends. When a character's Luck reaches 0, they lose—defeated, captured, or killed (your choice based on context).

Holmgang (Ritual Duel)

Holmgang (*"island-going"*) is a formalized duel to settle disputes, blood feuds, or honor challenges.

The Rules:

- Fought on an island, marked ground, or upon a cloak spread on earth
- Each combatant may bring three shields
- Fights to first blood, surrender, or death (agreed beforehand)
- **Refusing holmgang = dishonor** (gain "Coward" tag)
- **Winner** settles the matter; **loser's kin must accept outcome**

Mechanically: Use **Harm & Luck** resolution. Each successful blow destroys a shield (you have 3) or causes Luck damage. At 0 Luck, you are defeated.

Special: If agreed as **"to first blood,"** the conflict ends at **4 Luck** remaining (wounded but alive). If **"to death,"** it continues to 0 Luck.

Example:

> **You challenge a rival to holmgang over an insult.**
>
> Agreed terms: First blood.
>
> **Round 1**: *"Do I land the opening strike?"* → **Yes**: You deal 2 Luck damage. Rival: 4/6 Luck.
>
> **Round 2**: *"Does he break my guard?"* → **No, but...**: He fails to strike you, but you stumble (**"Off-Balance"** tag).

Round 3: *"Do I finish this before he recovers?"* → **Yes, and...**: You strike decisively, drawing first blood. Rival: 2/6 Luck. Holmgang ends. You win.

Outcome: Rival publicly yields. Matter settled. You gain "Holmgang Victor" tag (reputation boost).

Shield Wall Tactics

When fighting as part of a warband in formation:

Tag: "Shield Wall" applies to the group, not individuals.

- **Advantage**: Discipline, numbers, formation
- **Disadvantage**: If flanked, if morale breaks

Ask group-level questions: *"Does our shield wall hold against their charge?"*

Individual heroes can break from the wall for dramatic single combat, but this risks the formation.

Flyting (Verbal Duels)

Flyting is ritualized insult combat—trading verses and barbs to shame your opponent before witnesses.

When to Use:

- Feast halls
- Thing assemblies
- Before holmgang (traditional to exchange insults)
- Establishing dominance

How It Works:

1. **Declare flyting challenge**
2. **Both parties roll Oracle** (use appropriate skill tags: Silver-Tongued, Skald, etc.)
3. **Compare results:**

- **Winner**: Gains Advantage on next social action, opponent gains "Shamed by [Name]" tag (temporary Disadvantage)
- **Tie**: Crowd enjoys the spectacle, neither gains Advantage
- **Loser**: May challenge to holmgang if insult is severe

Example Flyting:

> **Opponent**: *"I hear you call yourself a warrior, yet your sword knows only the scabbard."*
>
> **You**: *"Bold words from one whose father was so ashamed, he drowned himself."*
>
> **Oracle Roll**: You have *Silver-Tongued* (Advantage), opponent has *Renowned Warrior* (intimidating, but not verbal). You roll 2 Chance dice vs. their 1. You win.
>
> **Result**: The crowd laughs. Opponent is shamed. You gain Advantage on your next request at the Thing.

Determining Next Scene Mood

At the end of the current scene sometimes you will be clear about the direction to take, other times you may need to determine the general mood of the next one. In this case roll 1d6 and consult the following table:

D6	Next Scene
1-3	Dramatic scene
4-5	Quiet Scene
6	Meanwhile...

- A **dramatic scene** does not break the tension of the previous scene but carries it further forward, introducing further obstacles or difficulties.
- During a **quiet scene** there is time to take a breath, to heal, to make plans for the next steps and to deepen relationships.
- A **meanwhile scene** takes place somewhere else, other than where the hero is. It cuts to villains or other plot-important characters.

Open-Ended Question or Get Inspired

To answer an Open-Ended question, roll 1d6 once on each of the Inspiration Tables (roll at least a verb and a noun, adjectives are optional).

THE HONOR SYSTEM

In Viking society, **reputation is everything**. Your worth is measured not by what you know yourself to be, but by what others say you are. Honor earned can elevate you to saga. Shame suffered can make you *níðingr*—a nothing.

The Three Pillars

DRENGSKAPR (Honorable Conduct)

- Courage in battle
- Keeping oaths
- Generosity to guests and followers
- Defending kin
- Speaking plainly
- Facing death without fear

When you act with *drengskapr*, you gain **Advantage** on related Oracle rolls. Your reputation grows. Witnesses spread your name.

NÍÐINGR (Ultimate Shame)

- Fleeing battle when honor demands you stand
- Breaking sworn oaths
- Betraying kin
- Sexual cowardice (a specific Norse insult)
- Refusing lawful challenge
- Being declared *níðingr* by the Thing

When you act shamefully, you gain **Disadvantage** on social actions. If declared *níðingr* at the Thing, you are **outlaw**—anyone may kill you without legal consequence.

ÓFRIÐR (Blood Feud)

- When your kin is killed, you **must** respond
- Failure to avenge = loss of honor
- Creates ongoing obligation tags: "Must Avenge [Name]"
- Can only be resolved through:
  - **Blood vengeance** (kill the killer)
  - **Holmgang** (ritual duel)
  - **Weregild** (compensation payment accepted by both sides)

Honor Tags in Play

As you play, you earn **reputation tags** that reflect how others see you:

Positive Tags:

- "Oath-Keeper" – You honor your word
- "Generous Host" – You give freely at feasts
- "Battle-Tested" – You stood when others fled
- "Silver-Tongued" – Your words sway the Thing
- "Kin-Loyal" – Family can count on you

Negative Tags:

- "Oath-Breaker" – You betrayed your word
- "Miserly" – You hoard rather than share
- "Coward" – You fled when honor demanded courage
- "Kinslayer" – You killed family (worst dishonor)
- "Nithing" – You are declared nothing

These tags grant **Advantage or Disadvantage** when relevant. "Oath-Keeper" helps in negotiations. "Kinslayer" destroys your social standing.

Nidstöng (Curse Pole)

The ultimate ritual curse. A pole raised with a horse's head, carved with runes, proclaiming your enemy *níðingr* and calling the landvættir to drive them out.

Mechanically:

- Requires public declaration at Thing or major gathering
- Target gains permanent **Disadvantage** on all social actions in that region
- Can only be removed by:
  - Killing the one who raised it
  - Public apology accepted at Thing
  - Exile (leaving the region entirely)

Blood Feuds & Weregild

Starting a Blood Feud: When kin is killed, you gain the tag: **"Must Avenge [Victim's Name]"**

This tag gives you:

- **Advantage** when acting to avenge (hunting killer, dueling, etc.)
- **Disadvantage** on all other actions until resolved (the obligation weighs on you)

Resolving the Feud:

1. **Blood Vengeance**: Kill the killer. Feud satisfied—but the killer's kin now have a feud with YOU.
2. **Holmgang**: Challenge to ritual duel (see Conflicts section). Winner settles the matter. Loser's kin must accept the outcome.
3. **Weregild**: Negotiate compensation at the Thing. Standard rates:
   - Thrall (slave): 12 ounces of silver
   - Free farmer: 24 ounces of silver
   - Hersir or goði: 48 ounces of silver
   - Jarl: 96 ounces of silver

   Both parties must publicly accept at Thing. Refusing offered weregild = shame.

Example: Honor in Action

Your jarl asks you to raid a monastery. You refuse, saying Christians are not worthy foes.

Oracle Question: *"Does the jarl accept my refusal without insult?"*

Consider: You have "Oath-Bound to Jarl" (obligation), but also "Honorable Warrior" (reputation). The jarl is known for temper.

Roll: If **No**, the jarl publicly insults you. You must:

- Challenge him to holmgang (dangerous—he's your lord)
- Accept the insult (gain "Shamed by Jarl" tag, **Disadvantage**)
- Leave his service (become oath-breaker unless done properly)

Witness Culture: This happened at the feast hall. Everyone saw. The skald will remember.

WYRD & FATE

Vikings believed in **örlög**—the web of past actions shaping present and future. You are not entirely free. Your deeds create consequences. But within those constraints, you choose.

Örlög (Personal Fate)

The past shapes the present. Every deed adds a thread to your örlög. Break an oath, and distrust follows you. Save a life, and you may be saved in turn.

Mechanically:

- Past actions become **Oracle modifiers**
- If you broke an oath before, the Oracle leans toward distrust
- If you were generous, the Oracle leans toward reciprocity
- The GM (you) interprets the Oracle through the lens of past deeds

Not Predetermined: Your fate is not fixed. The völva's prophecy may come true—but perhaps not how you expect. Trying to avoid fate may fulfill it (dramatic irony).

Hamingja (Family Luck)

Hamingja is spiritual power inherited from ancestors and built through honorable deeds. It can turn fate in your favor—but only briefly.

You start with 3 Hamingja points.

Spend Hamingja to:

1. **Reroll the Oracle** (any single Oracle roll)
2. **Declare Fortunate Coincidence** (a helpful NPC arrives, you find shelter, weather clears)

3. **Survive Death** (once per saga: when reduced to 0 Luck in combat, spend 2 Hamingja to survive with 1 Luck)

Gain Hamingja by:

- Completing sworn oaths (+1)
- Avenging kin (+1)
- Performing saga-worthy deeds (+1, GM judgment)
- Winning lawful holmgang (+1)
- Being praised by skald at major feast (+1)

Lose Hamingja by:

- Breaking sworn oaths (-2)
- Fleeing battle dishonorably (-1)
- Killing kin (-3)
- Being declared *níðingr* (-2)
- Bringing shame to family name (-1)

Maximum Hamingja: 6

Hamingja and Death: When your character dies, **1 Hamingja** passes to your next character (kin inheriting family luck). The rest is lost.

Prophecy & Dreams

Völvas speak prophecy. When you encounter one (Oracle determines), she may offer a reading:

1. **Ask a yes/no question about your fate**
2. **Roll the Oracle** (standard rules)
3. **The answer is true**—but interpretation may be unclear

Prophetic dreams occur at GM discretion (when dramatically appropriate):

- Roll on Omens table (provided later)
- Interpret symbolically
- May foreshadow conflicts, betrayals, or opportunities

Example Prophecy: > *"You will die with a sword in your hand and your name on men's lips."* > > This could mean: > > - Glorious death in battle (heroic interpretation) > - Murdered while holding a sword, people gossiping (dark interpretation) > - Dying of old age, clutching your famous blade, grandchildren speaking your name (peaceful interpretation)

The völva does not clarify. Fate is ambiguous.

SEASONAL RAIDING & TRAVEL

The Viking calendar drives the rhythm of the saga.

The Seasons

SPRING/SUMMER (Raiding Season)

- Sea travel becomes safe (April-September)
- Longships launch for raids, trade, exploration
- Thing assemblies occur
- Weddings and major feasts
- **Gain Advantage** on seafaring and raiding

FALL/WINTER (Home Season)

- Seas turn deadly (October-March)
- Communities shelter indoors
- Saga-telling, crafting, feuding by the fire
- Winter kills the unprepared
- **Gain Advantage** on endurance, survival, and indoor political intrigue

Longship Travel

A longship carries:

- 30-60 warriors
- Trade goods or plunder
- Supplies for weeks (not months)

- Your reputation (a famous ship has a name and saga)

Navigation:

- By sun and stars
- Landmarks and raven-flight
- Völva weather-reading
- Pure courage

Dangers:

- Storms (Oracle determines)
- Rocks and reefs
- Hostile fleets
- Sea-serpents (if the Oracle says so)

Mechanically: When traveling by sea, ask the Oracle: *"Do we reach [destination] without incident?"*

- **Yes**: Uneventful voyage
- **No**: Roll on Random Encounters or create complication
- **Yes, but**: You arrive, but damage ship / lose supplies / arrive late
- **No, and**: Serious disaster—shipwreck, attack, mutiny

Raiding

A successful raid requires:

1. **Target selection** (monastery, town, rival clan)
2. **Approach** (stealth, speed, overwhelming force)
3. **The raid itself** (Oracle determines success)
4. **Escape** (before defenders rally)

Consequences:

- Plunder (silver, slaves, livestock)
- Reputation (fear or fame)
- Enemies (survivors remember)
- Blood feuds (if you kill the wrong person)

Example: > *"We raid the monastery at dawn."* > > **Oracle Q:** "Do we catch them unprepared?" > → **Yes, and...** They have more treasure than expected. Gain double plunder, but a monk escapes and will report your ship's banner.

Settlement & Exploration

Finding new land:

- Iceland, Greenland, Vinland, or uncharted islands
- Requires long voyage with uncertain outcome
- Oracle determines what you find

Founding a settlement:

- Claim land
- Build hall and farm
- Survive first winter (Oracle: *"Do we survive winter without disaster?"*)
- Attract followers or family

Why settle new lands?

- Escape blood feuds
- Flee tyrant kings
- Seek wealth and independence
- Fulfill exile sentence

Mechanically: Settlement is **background** unless it becomes dramatic. The Oracle determines major events (crop failure, rival settlers, indigenous people, harsh winter, discovery of resources).

Winter Survival

The long dark tests you.

When winter comes, ask the Oracle: *"Does our household survive winter without crisis?"*

Yes: Spring comes. Life continues.

No: Roll 1d6 for crisis:

1. **Starvation** – Food runs out. Hunt, beg, or raid neighbors.
2. **Sickness** – Fever spreads. Völva or herbs required.
3. **Fire** – The hall burns. Rebuild or seek shelter.
4. **Feud Erupts** – Trapped together, old grudges explode.
5. **Visitor** – Stranger seeks shelter. Help or turn away?
6. **Omen** – Prophetic dream or supernatural event.

The Oracle helps you survive—or records how you died.

END OF SESSION: SAGA ADVANCEMENT

When your saga arc ends (whether in triumph, tragedy, or ongoing struggle), reflect on what changed.

Earning Bynames

If you performed saga-worthy deeds witnessed by others, **you earn a byname** reflecting those deeds:

- Killed a troll? → "Troll-Slayer"
- Survived impossible odds? → "the Fortunate"
- Led disastrous raid? → "the Unlucky"
- Never broke an oath? → "Oath-Keeper"

Bynames become **permanent tags** affecting your reputation.

Building Reputation

Add new **honor tags** based on how you acted:

- Kept oaths? → "Trustworthy"
- Broke oaths? → "Oath-Breaker"
- Generous at feasts? → "Generous Host"
- Fought bravely? → "Battle-Tested"

These tags accumulate, shaping how NPCs react to you.

Legacy & Inheritance

When your character dies:

- **Record their saga**: What did they accomplish? What byname did they earn?
- **Pass Hamingja**: 1 Hamingja point transfers to your next character (kinsman)
- **Inherit feuds**: Unfinished blood feuds pass to descendants
- **Claim reputation**: If you died well, descendants gain "Kin of [Famous Ancestor]" tag

Optional: Gaining New Skills

If you wish to add mechanical progression (not required):

- After major saga arc, add **1 new Skill tag** reflecting what you learned
- Maximum: 4 Skills total (keeps character simple)

BESTIARY: ENEMIES OF THE NORTH

11. Rival Jarl

Concept: Ambitious Warlord
Skills: Political Maneuvering, War Leadership
Frailty: Overconfident
Gear: Named Sword, Hall Full of Warriors
Goal: Expand territory
Motive: Legacy and power
Nemesis: You (rival for dominance)

12. Ambitious Hersir

Concept: Scheming Commander
Skills: Battle Tactics, Deception
Frailty: Cowardly in Single Combat
Gear: Fine Armor, Loyal Warband
Goal: Usurp the jarl

Motive: Believes he deserves rulership
Nemesis: The jarl and his loyalists

13. Outlaw Band Leader

Concept: Desperate Exile
Skills: Guerrilla Tactics, Survival
Frailty: Kinslayer (exiled for murder)
Gear: Stolen Weapons, Hidden Camp
Goal: Revenge on the jarl who outlawed him
Motive: Restore honor (or die trying)
Nemesis: Law-abiding society

14. Berserkr Warrior

Concept: Unstoppable Fury
Skills: Battle Rage, Pain Immunity
Frailty: Cannot Control Rage
Gear: Bear Pelt, Massive Axe
Goal: Die gloriously in battle
Motive: Embrace the fury
Nemesis: Anyone who challenges him

15. Scheming Kinsman

Concept: Treacherous Cousin
Skills: Lies, Political Manipulation
Frailty: Physical Coward
Gear: Poison, False Smile
Goal: Inherit family land
Motive: Greed and jealousy
Nemesis: The rightful heir (possibly you)

16. Vengeful Widow

Concept: Bereaved Avenger
Skills: Determination, Public Speaking
Frailty: Consumed by Grief

Gear: Husband's Sword, Blood-Debt Claim
Goal: Avenge husband's death
Motive: Honor his memory
Nemesis: Her husband's killer

21. Exiled Warrior

Concept: Honorless Wanderer
Skills: Swordsmanship, Survival
Frailty: Broken by Shame
Gear: Worn Blade, Tattered Cloak
Goal: Redemption or death
Motive: Escape the weight of dishonor
Nemesis: His past

22. Christian Missionary

Concept: Zealous Preacher
Skills: Persuasion, Latin Learning
Frailty: Cultural Outsider
Gear: Cross, Holy Book, Silver
Goal: Convert the pagans
Motive: Save souls (as he sees it)
Nemesis: The old gods and their followers

23. Slave Rebellion Leader

Concept: Escaped Thrall
Skills: Stealth, Rallying Oppressed
Frailty: Branded (marked as slave)
Gear: Improvised Weapons, Hidden Followers
Goal: Free all slaves
Motive: Vengeance against masters
Nemesis: Slave-owning society

24. Rival Skald

Concept: Competing Saga-Teller
Skills: Verbal Combat, Memory
Frailty: Jealous of Your Fame
Gear: Harp, Scathing Verses
Goal: Destroy your reputation
Motive: Be the greatest skald
Nemesis: You (rival for glory)

25. Jealous Rival

Concept: Envious Competitor
Skills: Sabotage, Rumor-Spreading
Frailty: Lacks Courage
Gear: False Friends, Secret Schemes
Goal: See you fail
Motive: You have what they want
Nemesis: Your success

26. Frankish Knight

Concept: Armored Defender
Skills: Heavy Cavalry, Christian Zeal
Frailty: Slow in Rough Terrain
Gear: Plate Armor, Lance, Warhorse
Goal: Defend Christendom from heathens
Motive: Faith and duty
Nemesis: Viking raiders

31. Irish Monk-Warrior

Concept: Holy Defender
Skills: Staff-Fighting, Scripture Knowledge
Frailty: Bound by Vows
Gear: Iron-Shod Staff, Holy Relic
Goal: Protect monastery

Motive: Faith in God
Nemesis: Pagan raiders

32. Saxon Thegn

Concept: English Noble
Skills: Sword & Board, Leadership
Frailty: Hates All Norsemen
Gear: Fine Sword, Shield, Mail
Goal: Drive Vikings from England
Motive: Reclaim stolen lands
Nemesis: The Danelaw

33. Greedy Merchant

Concept: Unscrupulous Trader
Skills: Negotiation, Deception
Frailty: Cowardly
Gear: Trade Goods, Hidden Dagger
Goal: Accumulate wealth
Motive: Greed
Nemesis: Honest traders

34. Oath-Breaker

Concept: Dishonored Warrior
Skills: Combat, Desperation
Frailty: Shunned by All
Gear: Broken Oath-Ring, Stolen Gear
Goal: Survive despite shame
Motive: Escape consequences
Nemesis: Those he betrayed

35. Kinslayer

Concept: Family Murderer
Skills: Stealth, Ruthlessness
Frailty: Haunted by the Dead

Gear: Blood-Stained Blade
Goal: Escape blood feud
Motive: Fear of vengeance
Nemesis: Entire bloodline hunts him

36. Nithing (Outlaw)

Concept: Declared Non-Person
Skills: Survival, Hiding
Frailty: May Be Killed Without Legal Consequence
Gear: Whatever he can scavenge
Goal: Survive exile
Motive: Hope for pardon
Nemesis: All lawful society

41. Völva (Hostile)

Concept: Cursing Seeress
Skills: Seidr Magic, Prophecy
Frailty: Physically Frail
Gear: Staff, Bones, Ritual Herbs
Goal: Enact revenge through curses
Motive: Someone wronged her
Nemesis: Her target

42. Sami Shaman

Concept: Northern Spirit-Speaker
Skills: Drum Magic, Nature Mastery
Frailty: Outsider to Norse Culture
Gear: Ritual Drum, Reindeer Hide
Goal: Protect his people
Motive: Vikings encroach on Sami lands
Nemesis: Norse settlers

43. Rival Goði

Concept: Competing Chieftain-Priest
Skills: Law-Speaking, Authority
Frailty: Bound by Tradition
Gear: Oath-Ring, Temple Authority
Goal: Control the Thing
Motive: Political power
Nemesis: Rival goðar

44. Blood-Feuding Clan

Concept: Multi-Generational Vengeance
Skills: Organization, Numbers
Frailty: Consumed by Hatred
Gear: Warriors, Resources
Goal: Annihilate rival clan
Motive: Ancient grievance
Nemesis: The other clan

45. Pirate Captain

Concept: Sea Raider
Skills: Naval Combat, Ruthlessness
Frailty: No Honor (even among Vikings)
Gear: Fast Ship, Desperate Crew
Goal: Plunder without rules
Motive: Wealth and freedom
Nemesis: All honest sailors

46. Byzantine Varangian

Concept: Elite Guard
Skills: Axe-Fighting, Loyalty to Emperor
Frailty: Far from Home
Gear: Varangian Axe, Byzantine Armor
Goal: Serve with honor

Motive: Wealth and glory in foreign service
Nemesis: Enemies of Byzantium

51. Draugr (Revenant)

Concept: Undead Guardian
Skills: Superhuman Strength, Undying
Frailty: Bound to Burial Mound
Gear: Ancient Weapons, Cursed Treasure
Goal: Guard its hoard
Motive: Greed beyond death
Nemesis: Grave-robbers

52. Troll

Concept: Mountain Monster
Skills: Brute Strength, Stone Skin
Frailty: Weak to Sunlight
Gear: Boulders, Clubs
Goal: Eat humans
Motive: Hunger
Nemesis: Daylight

53. Landvættir (Angry Spirit)

Concept: Territorial Guardian
Skills: Curse-Weaving, Local Mastery
Frailty: Cannot Leave Its Domain
Gear: None (spiritual)
Goal: Drive intruders away
Motive: Protect sacred place
Nemesis: Settlers and desecrators

54. Haugbúi (Barrow-Dweller)

Concept: Intelligent Undead
Skills: Bargaining, Curses
Frailty: Bound to Grave

Gear: Ancient Treasures
Goal: Rest undisturbed
Motive: Protect burial hoard
Nemesis: Those who disturb its rest

55. Mare (Nightmare Spirit)

Concept: Dream-Stalker
Skills: Sleep Paralysis, Fear
Frailty: Powerless Against Waking
Gear: None (ethereal)
Goal: Feed on terror
Motive: Malevolent nature
Nemesis: Iron, prayers, rowan wood

56. Huldra (Forest Spirit)

Concept: Deceptive Beauty
Skills: Glamour, Seduction
Frailty: Hollow Back (reveals true form)
Gear: None (shapeshifter)
Goal: Lure men to doom
Motive: Nature's vengeance on humans
Nemesis: Those who see through glamour

61. Nøkk (Water Spirit)

Concept: Lake Predator
Skills: Shapeshifting, Drowning
Frailty: Cannot Leave Water
Gear: None (spiritual)
Goal: Drown the living
Motive: Malicious nature
Nemesis: Dry land

62. Jötunn (Giant-Kin)

Concept: Ancient Enemy
Skills: Massive Size, Ice Magic
Frailty: Slow, Ancient Grudges
Gear: Boulder-Sized Weapons
Goal: Destroy human settlements
Motive: Hatred of mortals
Nemesis: Thor and his followers

63. Fenrisúlfr (Great Wolf)

Concept: Monstrous Predator
Skills: Unstoppable Hunting, Fear
Frailty: Bound by Destiny
Gear: None (natural weapons)
Goal: Hunt and devour
Motive: Hunger and rage
Nemesis: The gods

64. Shape-Shifter (Hostile)

Concept: Hamramr Sorcerer
Skills: Beast Form, Stealth
Frailty: Vulnerable While Sleeping
Gear: Hidden Human Form
Goal: Hunt without detection
Motive: Cursed nature
Nemesis: Those who discover the truth

65. Cursed Warrior

Concept: Living Curse
Skills: Unstoppable Combat, Pain Immunity
Frailty: Curse Spreads to Others
Gear: Cursed Weapon
Goal: Die (but cannot)

Motive: End the curse
Nemesis: The one who cursed him

66. Níðhöggr's Spawn (Serpent)

Concept: World-Serpent's Child
Skills: Poison, Crushing Coils
Frailty: Arrogant
Gear: None (natural weapons)
Goal: Consume all
Motive: Inherited malice
Nemesis: Heroes and dragon-slayers

ADVENTURE TABLES: THE THREADS OF SAGA

When you need inspiration or must answer an open-ended question, roll 2d6 on these tables.

NPCs: Rivals, Allies & Enemies

D66	NPC
11	A wandering skald who knows your deeds
12	A disgraced hersir seeking redemption
13	A völva who speaks unwelcome prophecy
14	A rival warrior challenging your reputation
15	A jarl's daughter (political marriage opportunity)
16	A cursed kinsman who brings misfortune
21	An exiled warrior from your homeland
22	A Christian monk attempting conversion
23	A merchant offering dubious deals
24	A blood-feuding clansman seeking alliance
25	A loyal oath-sworn companion
26	A scheming goði manipulating the Thing

D66	NPC
31	A slave who knows dangerous secrets
32	A shipwright who builds famous vessels
33	A widow demanding weregild
34	A berserkr for hire
35	A rival skald spreading damaging rumors
36	A shape-shifter in human form
41	A foreign warrior seeking glory in the North
42	A healer with mysterious knowledge
43	A jarl's spy watching you
44	A blacksmith who forges legendary weapons
45	A child prophesied for greatness
46	An oath-breaker hiding in exile
51	A Sami guide who knows the wilderness
52	A Byzantine merchant from Constantinople
53	A Saxon refugee fleeing war
54	A kinsman who owes you weregild
55	A völva's apprentice learning seidr
56	A rival captain competing for crew
61	A hostage from a defeated enemy
62	A settler seeking land in Iceland
63	A poet-chronicler recording your saga
64	A thrall rebellion leader
65	A mysterious stranger with hidden identity
66	Your own kinsman returned from the dead

Sacred Sites & Notable Locations

D66	Location
11	Thingvellir (Iceland's parliament site)
12	Uppsala Temple (Sweden's sacred center)
13	Ancient burial mound (draugr-haunted)
14	Sacred grove (landvættir dwell here)
15	Coastal fortress under siege
16	Abandoned settlement (plague or curse)
21	Thing assembly grounds
22	Jarl's great hall
23	Hidden fjord (perfect for ambush)
24	Monastery ripe for raiding
25	Trading post at crossroads
26	Volcanic hot springs (healing waters)
31	Mountain pass (troll territory)
32	Shipyard building longships
33	Blót altar stone (blood-stained)
34	Frozen lake (winter shortcut or trap)
35	Sea-cave hiding place
36	Ruined fort from earlier wars
41	Hedeby (Denmark's great market)
42	Jorvik (York, Viking-ruled England)
43	Dublin (Irish-Viking trade hub)
44	Constantinople (Byzantium, far south)
45	Paris (tempting raid target)
46	Vinland (mysterious western land)
51	Greenland ice-edge settlement

D66	Location
52	Faroe Islands (sheep and storms)
53	Shetland and Orkney (stepping stones)
54	Lindisfarne (infamous first raid site)
55	Vast forest (easy to get lost)
56	Glacier's edge (supernatural boundary)
61	Whale-bone beach (omen-place)
62	Salmon river (bounty or starvation)
63	Enemy clan's farmstead
64	Runestone forest (ancestors' names)
65	Battlefield graveyard (restless dead)
66	Portal to the Otherworld (one-way?)

Quests & Blood Feuds

D66	Quest Hook
11	Avenge kinsman killed in ambush
12	Retrieve stolen family heirloom
13	Clear your name at the Thing
14	Win holmgang to settle dispute
15	Lead raid on wealthy monastery
16	Settle Iceland and survive first winter
21	Escort völva to sacred site
22	Hunt draugr terrorizing valley
23	Negotiate weregild with hostile clan
24	Discover who murdered the jarl
25	Prevent blood feud escalation
26	Claim inheritance disputed by rival

D66	Quest Hook
31	Break curse on kinsman
32	Rescue captured family from slavers
33	Find new trade route to Byzantium
34	Survive outlawry sentence (3 winters)
35	Unite warring factions against invaders
36	Recover lost ship from storm
41	Prove innocence in oath-breaking charge
42	Defend settlement from pirate raid
43	Win bride through trial or combat
44	Fulfill prophecy spoken at your birth
45	Hunt legendary beast terrorizing region
46	Overthrow tyrant jarl (lawfully or not)
51	Find Vinland and return to tell the tale
52	Protect Christian convert from persecution
53	End generations-old blood feud
54	Discover why crops fail (curse? Spirits?)
55	Expose traitor in your warband
56	Retrieve völva's stolen seidr staff
61	Win place in Varangian Guard
62	Defeat rival in verbal flyting contest
63	Establish new Thing in lawless region
64	Carry message through enemy territory
65	Prevent kinsman from dishonoring family
66	Face the draugr that was once your father

Raids & Expeditions

D66	Raid/Voyage
11	Wealthy Irish monastery (easy target)
12	Frankish coastal town (defended)
13	English village (Saxon resistance)
14	Rival clan's cattle (traditional raid)
15	Muslim merchant ship (Mediterranean)
16	Scottish island settlement
21	Trade mission to Byzantium
22	Explore western ocean (Vinland?)
23	Rescue mission to foreign prison
24	Smuggling run past jarl's taxes
25	Retrieve holy relic for Christian ally
26	Map uncharted coastline
31	Raid rival jarl's hall (risky!)
32	Capture specific hostage for ransom
33	Destroy pirate base threatening trade
34	Establish new settlement on Iceland
35	Hunt whales for oil and bone
36	Carry exiled völva to sacred site
41	Join Great Heathen Army invasion
42	Voyage to Kiev (Rus territories)
43	Raid Sami camp for furs (provokes spirits)
44	Escort merchant caravan safely
45	Search for legendary treasure hoard
46	Punitive raid against oath-breakers
51	Winter voyage (desperate or mad?)

D66	Raid/Voyage
52	Diplomatic mission to Christian king
53	Investigate ghost ship sighting
54	Race rival crew to new land
55	Retrieve völva's prophecy ingredients
56	Plunder battlefield corpses (shameful?)
61	Join Varangian Guard in Byzantium
62	Colonize Greenland's ice edge
63	Hunt sea-serpent threatening harbor
64	Steal bride from rival clan (tradition?)
65	Find crew for cursed ship
66	Voyage beyond the world's edge

Omens & Signs

D66	Omen
11	Ravens gather (Odin watches)
12	Northern lights dance (spirits restless)
13	Whale beached (bounty or curse?)
14	Eagle circles overhead (victory comes)
15	Storm rises from clear sky
16	Fog rolls in at noon (Otherworld near)
21	Wolf howls three times
22	Your weapon breaks unexpectedly
23	Dream of drowning
24	Milk turns to blood
25	Horse refuses to move forward
26	Völva's prophecy manifests

D66	Omen
31	Corpse-light on burial mound
32	Fish leap from water in thousands
33	Ice breaks underfoot
34	Sword sings in scabbard
35	Fire refuses to light
36	Child speaks in dead language
41	Ship's dragon-head falls off
42	Ale turns sour overnight
43	Landvættir appears as white deer
44	Stars form unfamiliar pattern
45	Earthquake shakes hall
46	Bread moldy before baking
51	Ravens speak human words
52	Snow falls in summer
53	Ship's wake glows with light
54	Dead man's ghost walks
55	Thunder without storm
56	Fylgja appears (death omen)
61	Stranger foretells your doom
62	Runestone bleeds
63	All dogs howl at once
64	Your shadow moves wrong
65	Breath freezes though warm
66	You see your own corpse

Random Encounters

D66	Encounter
11	Traveling merchant with exotic goods
12	Exhausted refugees fleeing war
13	Hunting party from rival clan
14	Lone berserkr seeking worthy foe
15	Christian pilgrims (easy prey or allies?)
16	Lost child crying for parents
21	Wounded warrior with warning
22	Völva offering prophecy (for price)
23	Skald collecting sagas
24	Funeral procession
25	Outlaw band demanding toll
26	Friendly settlement offering hospitality
31	Rival ship on collision course
32	Mysterious hermit in wilderness
33	Wedding party traveling to feast
34	Slave coffle being marched
35	Thing assembly in session
36	Ghost asking for burial
41	Troll blocking mountain pass
42	Landvættir warning you away
43	Draugr emerging from mound
44	Storm driving ships to shore
45	Wild animals fleeing something
46	Abandoned longship (cursed?)
51	Foreign warriors lost and desperate

D66	Encounter
52	Kinsman you thought dead
53	Ambush by blood-feuding family
54	Livestock mysteriously dead
55	Sacred site being desecrated
56	Sami traders offering furs
61	Rival challenging to holmgang
62	Shipwreck survivors pleading
63	Mare riding a sleeping person
64	Völva mid-seidr trance
65	Old enemy seeking reconciliation
66	Oath-sworn companion returns

Complications & Betrayals

D66	Complication
11	Ally revealed as oath-breaker
12	Reward is cursed
13	Innocent dies because of your action
14	Enemy escapes to seek revenge
15	Völva's prophecy twists meaning
16	Your geis triggers at worst moment
21	Loved one forced to betray you
22	Clan turns against you
23	Weather traps you in hostile place
24	Ship damaged beyond quick repair
25	Trusted companion dies fulfilling oath
26	Victory causes larger blood feud

D66	Complication
31	Kinsman challenges your honor
32	Weregild rejected, feud continues
33	Sacred site becomes corrupted
34	Jarl demands impossible service
35	Rival gains your secret weakness
36	Enemy uses your tactics against you
41	Prophecy was misinterpreted
42	Companion revealed as spy
43	Curse spreads to innocent
44	Skald sings your downfall
45	Reputation makes you famous target
46	Freed captive was more valuable imprisoned
51	Supernatural debt comes due
52	Oath conflicts with blood feud
53	Winter comes early, trapping you
54	Love interest chooses rival
55	Child inherits your curse
56	Victory earns jarl's jealousy
61	Kinsman of slain enemy hunts you
62	Magic item slowly corrupts you
63	Ally enslaved by seidr
64	Sacred oath binds you to enemy
65	Fame attracts wrong attention
66	The gods demand sacrifice

Treasures & Artifacts

D66	Treasure
11	Named sword (Leg-Biter, Blood-Drinker)
12	Silver arm-ring (mark of wealth)
13	Runestone with prophecy
14	Ancestral helmet
15	Drinking horn carved with saga
16	Cloak that sheds water
21	Thrall-worth of silver (12 oz)
22	Ship with famous name
23	Bear-skin cloak
24	Amber necklace (trade value)
25	Byzantine silk
26	Arab silver dirham hoard
31	Monastery gold cross
32	Rune-carved staff
33	Jarl's gift-ring (political debt)
34	Völva's seidr implements
35	Map to unknown land
36	Oath-ring binding many
41	Cursed weapon (powerful but doomed)
42	Holy relic (Christian)
43	Walrus ivory
44	Furs worth small fortune
45	Ancient torc (pre-Viking)
46	Slave who knows secrets
51	Land deed to Iceland

D66	Treasure
52	Ship's share (part ownership)
53	Enchanted dice (always lucky?)
54	Draugr's hoard
55	Varangian armor
56	Frankish wine (luxury)
61	Seidr-woven cloth
62	Horn summoning warriors
63	Shield never broken
64	Boots that never wear out
65	Ring granting safe passage
66	Hammer blessed by Thor

Seasonal Events & Blóts

D66	Event
11	Spring Blót (sacrifice for good season)
12	Thing assembly convenes
13	First ship launches (raiding season)
14	Wedding feast
15	Holmgang duel scheduled
16	Völva prophecy gathering
21	Midsummer festival
22	First harvest celebration
23	Autumn Blót (thanks for harvest)
24	Livestock slaughter for winter
25	Saga-telling competition
26	Flyting contest

D66	Event
31	Winter Blót (survival prayers)
32	Yule feast (darkest night)
33	Ice-breaking ceremony
34	Naming ceremony for child
35	Funeral rites
36	Oath-swearing ceremony
41	Ship consecration
42	Seidr ritual (public)
43	Champion’s tournament
44	Trade fair gathering
45	Blood-eagle execution (grim)
46	Reconciliation feast
51	Viking games (athletics)
52	New goði installation
53	Boundary-stone blessing
54	Kinship ceremony (adoption)
55	Outlawry proclamation
56	Ship-burning funeral
61	Eclipse observation (omen)
62	First snow ritual
63	Rune-stone raising
64	Weregild payment ceremony
65	Conversion debate (Christians vs. pagans)
66	Ragnarök portent claimed

Thing Assemblies & Politics

D66	Political Event
11	Lawsuit against you for killing
12	Dispute over land boundaries
13	Goði election (political maneuvering)
14	Outlawry vote on criminal
15	Trade agreement negotiation
16	Marriage alliance proposed
21	Witness testimony contradicts yours
22	Blood feud arbitration
23	New law proposed
24	Jarl demands increased taxes
25	Rival challenges your testimony
26	Secret alliance formed
31	Skald publicly shames rival
32	Völva prophesies at Thing
33	Christian missionary speaks
34	Holmgang challenge issued
35	Weregild amount contested
36	Oath-breaking accusation
41	Thrall granted freedom
42	Land inheritance dispute
43	Trade monopoly challenged
44	Declaration of war vote
45	Kinslayer judged
46	Goði corruption exposed
51	Factions form over issue

D66	Political Event
52	Bribery scandal
53	Ancient law invoked
54	Precedent-setting case
55	Exile sentence debated
56	Reconciliation attempted
61	Rival buys votes
62	Your reputation tested
63	Thing disrupted by violence
64	New settlement granted autonomy
65	Religious conversion debated
66	Jarl overthrown legally

Ship Names & Characteristics

D66	Ship
11	Wave-Strider (swift, good in storms)
12	Raven's Wing (black sail, ominous)
13	Sea-Serpent (dragon-headed prow)
14	Storm-Rider (weathered, reliable)
15	Blood-Drinker (red-painted hull)
16	Wind-Dancer (fastest in fleet)
21	Wolf of the Waves (aggressive raider)
22	Fjord-Glider (shallow draft)
23	Thunder-Striker (heavy, battle-ship)
24	Ice-Breaker (reinforced prow)
25	Whale-Hunter (whaling vessel)
26	Silver-Bringer (merchant ship)

D66	Ship
31	Dragon’s Breath (fire-ship capability)
32	Foam-Cutter (sleek design)
33	Skar-Bringer (feared by enemies)
34	Tide-Turner (lucky ship)
35	Raven-Feeder (brings death)
36	Sky-Seeker (tall mast)
41	Snake of the Sea (long, sinuous)
42	Odin’s Gift (blessed by völva)
43	Shield-Maiden (crewed by women)
44	Frost-Fang (winter raider)
45	Wave-Treader (ocean-crossing)
46	Saga-Worthy (famous in stories)
51	Bone-Grinder (wrecks enemies)
52	Wind-Whisperer (silent approach)
53	Star-Follower (navigator’s pride)
54	Reef-Dancer (knows hidden waters)
55	Death’s Herald (all fear its sail)
56	Fortune-Seeker (explorer’s ship)
61	Wave-Splitter (powerful rower)
62	Ghost-Ship (appears from fog)
63	Jarl’s Pride (finest in fleet)
64	Sea-Wolf’s Fang (pirate vessel)
65	Homeland-Lost (exile’s ship)
66	Valhalla-Bound (cursed to sink?)

Viking Settlements & Communities

D66	Settlement
11	Prosperous coastal village
12	Struggling inland farm
13	Fortified hill-fort
14	New Iceland homestead
15	Trading post at river junction
16	Abandoned settlement (why?)
21	Fishing village on fjord
22	Wealthy jarl's estate
23	Religious center (temple)
24	Craftsman's workshop cluster
25	Slave market town
26	Shipbuilding harbor
31	Winter refuge cave-village
32	Mountaintop signal station
33	Quarrelsome family compound
34	Peaceful farming valley
35	Disputed border settlement
36	Plague-stricken village
41	Bandit hideout (outlaws)
42	Sacred grove with shrine
43	Iron-mining community
44	Salt-production settlement
45	Fur-trading outpost
46	Livestock-herding summer camp
51	Island hermitage

D66	Settlement
52	Burned-out ruins (recent)
53	Thrall rebellion stronghold
54	Mixed Norse-native settlement
55	Seer's isolated dwelling
56	Berserkr training camp
61	Wealthy merchant's compound
62	Frontier fort (far north)
63	Secret meeting place
64	Cursed settlement (everyone dead)
65	Multi-clan neutral ground
66	Gateway to Otherworld

Weather & Sea Conditions

D66	Conditions
11	Clear skies, favorable wind
12	Light rain, steady progress
13	Fog bank (navigation difficult)
14	Building storm clouds
15	Sudden squall from nowhere
16	Dead calm (becalmed)
21	Fierce gale (dangerous)
22	Ice forming on rigging
23	Heavy snow obscuring vision
24	Aurora borealis overhead
25	Lightning strikes nearby
26	Unseasonable warmth

D66	Conditions
31	Perfect sailing weather
32	Shifting winds (tricky)
33	Wall of rain approaching
34	Towering waves (storm surge)
35	Hail pounding deck
36	Mist that moves wrong
41	Whirlpool or maelstrom
42	Waterspout (tornado at sea)
43	Sea unusually calm (ominous)
44	Current pulling off course
45	Icebergs blocking route
46	Blood-red sunrise (omen)
51	Following winds (Odin's favor?)
52	Freezing spray coating ship
53	Sun-dogs (ice crystals, beautiful)
54	Heat lightning without thunder
55	Sudden temperature drop
56	Waves breaking in patterns
61	Storm that lasts three days
62	Unnatural green sky
63	Tide running wrong direction
64	Water glowing with light
65	Wind dies at crucial moment
66	Impossible storm (supernatural?)

Dreams & Prophecies

D66	Dream/Vision
11	You drown in cold water
12	Your sword breaks in battle
13	A raven speaks your name
14	Dead kinsman gives warning
15	You sit on throne of bones
16	Ship sinks beneath you
21	Feasting in Valhalla
22	Walking through fire unburned
23	Your enemy offers peace
24	Child born with strange mark
25	Tree with your name falls
26	Wolf follows you everywhere
31	Blood moon rises
32	You wear jarl's crown
33	Loved one betrays you
34	Finding vast treasure hoard
35	Fighting your own shadow
36	Völva points at you, silent
41	All your teeth fall out
42	Walking among corpses
43	Ship with black sails arrives
44	Your hall burns down
45	Killing someone you love
46	Being buried alive
51	Riding eight-legged horse

D66	Dream/Vision
52	Serpent coiled around you
53	Speaking in unknown tongue
54	Your reflection attacks you
55	Valkyrie choosing warriors
56	Walking on water
61	Building bridge over abyss
62	Eagle tears out your eyes
63	Weeping over unnamed grave
64	Standing before Thing, silent
65	Your offspring kill each other
66	Ragnarök begins (world ending)

Feast Hall Events

D66	Event
11	Generous gift-giving by jarl
12	Skald performs epic saga
13	Drinking contest erupts
14	Flyting duel begins
15	Wedding announcement
16	Oaths sworn publicly
21	Unexpected guest arrives
22	Food runs out (shame)
23	Fire breaks out
24	Poisoning suspected
25	Brawl over insult
26	Alliance proposed

D66	Event
31	Völva prophesies at feast
32	Challenge to holmgang issued
33	Slave freed publicly
34	Inheritance announced
35	Ghost appears to all
36	Betrayal revealed
41	Magnificent entertainment
42	Honored guest insults host
43	Romantic liaison discovered
44	Political coup attempted
45	Religious conversion debated
46	Blood feud reconciliation
51	Jarl dies mid-feast
52	Enemy attacks during meal
53	Troll breaks into hall
54	Ale mysteriously sours
55	Cursed gift revealed
56	Rival clan arrives uninvited
61	Champion’s boast challenged
62	Secret lover exposed
63	Weregild payment made
64	Future jarl proclaimed
65	Hall blessed by goði
66	Otherworldly music heard

Skills & Challenges

D66	Challenge
11	Navigate by stars alone
12	Climb sheer cliff face
13	Swim across freezing fjord
14	Track enemy through forest
15	Survive three days without food
16	Break wild horse
21	Forge weapon from scratch
22	Compose winning flyting verse
23	Read ancient runes
24	Perform complex seidr ritual
25	Wrestle champion warrior
26	Drink entire barrel of ale
31	Lift massive stone
32	Shoot arrow through ring
33	Endure pain without flinching
34	Negotiate impossible deal
35	Remember complex genealogy
36	Find water in wasteland
41	Repair damaged ship at sea
42	Tame wild falcon
43	Survive lightning strike
44	Win at dice against cheater
45	Cure mysterious illness
46	Speak convincingly at Thing
51	Resist völva's curse

D66	Challenge
52	Escape from bonds
53	Hold breath underwater
54	Convince enemy to surrender
55	Survive shipwreck
56	Out-drink rival
61	Calm panicked warriors
62	Interpret complex omen
63	Build shelter in blizzard
64	Win race against time
65	Resist supernatural fear
66	Face death without terror

Trade Goods & Merchants

D66	Trade Item/Merchant
11	Amber from Baltic shores
12	Walrus ivory tusks
13	Arctic fox furs (valuable)
14	Iron ore and ingots
15	Whale oil and bone
16	Seal skins
21	Honey and beeswax
22	Salted fish (barrels)
23	Wheat from Denmark
24	Timber for shipbuilding
25	Rope and cordage
26	Tar for waterproofing

D66	Trade Item/Merchant
31	Byzantine silk (luxury)
32	Arab silver coins
33	Frankish wine (rare)
34	English wool
35	Irish gold jewelry
36	Sami reindeer hides
41	Slaves (thralls)
42	Horses from Iceland
43	Hawks for hunting
44	Hunting dogs
45	Weapons (swords, axes)
46	Chainmail armor
51	Dyes and pigments
52	Salt (preservative)
53	Spices from east
54	Glass beads
55	Bronze jewelry
56	Carved bone items
61	Scheming merchant (cheats)
62	Honest trader (rare)
63	Foreign merchant (exotic)
64	Desperate seller (bargain)
65	Smuggler (illegal goods)
66	Merchant-spy (gathering info)

Weapons & Equipment Details

D66	Item
11	Perfectly balanced sword
12	Notched battle-axe
13	Bent shield (needs repair)
14	Helm with raven wings
15	Spear with runic shaft
16	Broken chainmail
21	Bow with bone arrows
22	Seax (fighting knife)
23	Throwing axes (pair)
24	Grandfather's sword (heirloom)
25	Captured foreign blade
26	Cursed weapon (unlucky)
31	Shield with beast design
32	Armor too small/large
33	Ceremonial weapon (fragile)
34	Tool doubling as weapon
35	Poison-coated dagger
36	Enchanted spearhead
41	Heavy two-handed axe
42	Weathered but reliable blade
43	Beautifully decorated useless sword
44	Crude but effective club
45	Expensive but poor quality
46	Weapon with dark history
51	Shield boss with hidden spike

D66	Item
52	Collapsible travel bow
53	Chain for restraining enemies
54	Net for fighting
55	Weighted rope
56	Fire-starting kit
61	Emergency rations
62	Water skin (leather)
63	Warm cloak (winter survival)
64	Rope and grappling hook
65	Lock picks and tools
66	Lucky charm (does it work?)

Clan Relationships

D66	Relationship
11	Allied through marriage
12	Ancient blood feud
13	Recent reconciliation (fragile)
14	Trade partners
15	Mutual enemies unite them
16	Disputed border territory
21	Sworn brotherhood pact
22	Grudging respect
23	Competitive rivalry
24	One clan owes weregild
25	Secret alliance
26	Open warfare

D66	Relationship
31	Shared Thing assembly
32	Religious differences
33	One clan serves the other
34	Intermarriage banned
35	Neutral but suspicious
36	One clan exiled the other
41	Competing for jarl's favor
42	Shared ancestor claimed
43	Prophecy binds fates
44	One stole other's land
45	United against outsiders
46	Historical betrayal unforgiven
51	Younger clan honors elder
52	Both claim same glory
53	Economic dependency
54	One protects the other
55	Cultural differences divide
56	Ritual combat tradition
61	Elder generation feuds, youth friendly
62	Marriage alliance negotiating
63	One cursed by other's völva
64	Shared sacred site
65	Competition over resources
66	Destined to merge or destroy

Supernatural Encounters

D66	Encounter
11	Draugr rises from mound
12	Landvættir demands offering
13	Troll demands toll
14	Völva in seidr trance
15	Ghost seeking burial
16	Huldra's seduction attempt
21	Mare rides sleeping victim
22	Fylgja appears as death omen
23	Nøkk lurks in water
24	Mysterious lights in forest
25	Voices from burial mound
26	Otherworldly music
31	Animals acting strangely
32	Time moves wrong
33	Prophecy manifests literally
34	Curse activates
35	Hamramr spotted (shapeshifter)
36	Portal to Otherworld opens
41	Dead warrior walks
42	Berserker's rage goes wrong
43	Seidr magic backfires
44	Sacred grove rejects you
45	Runestone bleeds
46	Ancestors speak through child
51	Weather obeys völva

D66	Encounter
52	Weapon comes alive
53	Island wasn't there before
54	Time loop encountered
55	Giants seen in distance
56	World-serpent sighting
61	Valkyrie chooses fallen
62	Odin's ravens observe
63	Otherworldly feast invitation
64	Your shadow acts independently
65	Speaking with dead kinsman
66	Ragnarök portent (false alarm?)

Journey Complications

D66	Complication
11	Bridge washed out
12	Path blocked by landslide
13	Guide gets lost
14	Food spoils unexpectedly
15	Horse goes lame
16	River flooded, uncrossable
21	Blizzard forces shelter
22	Bandits demand toll
23	Sacred site blocks route
24	Troll territory ahead
25	Local lord forbids passage
26	Plague zone must avoid

D66	Complication
31	Ship needs emergency repairs
32	Crew member falls ill
33	Navigation error (lost)
34	Supplies stolen at night
35	Rival group racing you
36	Supernatural fog descends
41	Ice breaks underfoot
42	Pursued by enemies
43	Wrong information given
44	Map is inaccurate
45	Weather turns deadly
46	Mutiny brewing
51	Landmark destroyed/moved
52	Must detour for blood feud
53	Someone recognizes you (bad)
54	Oath forces you elsewhere
55	Prophecy warns against route
56	Equipment failure
61	Political situation changed
62	Deadline approaching
63	Companion has secret agenda
64	Locals hostile to outsiders
65	Natural disaster blocks way
66	Destination no longer exists

Reputation & Fame Events

D66	Reputation Event
11	Skald spreads your fame
12	Skald spreads damaging lies
13	Witnesses exaggerate your deed
14	Credit stolen by rival
15	Your cowardice becomes known
16	Heroic deed goes unwitnessed
21	Foreign lands hear your name
22	Compared favorably to legend
23	Mocked for failure
24	Kinsman shames family name
25	Marriage offers increase
26	Assassination attempts increase
31	Children named after you
32	Saga composed about you
33	Rivals challenge constantly
34	Sought for advice
35	Shunned by community
36	Welcomed everywhere
41	Price on your head
42	Jarl seeks your service
43	Völva prophecies your doom
44	Youth idolize you
45	Elders disapprove
46	Other clans fear you
51	Reputation precedes you

D66	Reputation Event
52	Mistaken for someone else
53	Legend greater than reality
54	True deeds forgotten
55	Enemy spreads counter-stories
56	Reputation attracts trouble
61	Byname becomes permanent
62	Fame brings responsibilities
63	Expected to perform miracles
64	Cannot escape past deeds
65	Reputation opens doors
66	Immortalized in saga

Combat Situations

D66	Battle Scenario
11	Ambush from forest
12	Open field battle
13	Fighting uphill
14	Defending stronghold
15	Naval boarding action
16	Duel at dawn
21	Fighting in thick fog
22	Surrounded by enemies
23	Protecting non-combatants
24	Fighting retreat
25	Last stand scenario
26	Surprise night raid

D66	Battle Scenario
31	Shield wall clash
32	Skirmish in ruins
33	Fighting on ice
34	Burning building escape
35	Underwater struggle
36	Mounted vs. foot combat
41	Fighting in storm
42	Narrow bridge battle
43	Multiple opponents
44	Friendly fire risk
45	Hostages complicate fight
46	Ritual combat rules
51	Terrain collapsing
52	Fighting while fleeing
53	Protecting valuable cargo
54	Outnumbered badly
55	Fighting supernatural foe
56	Weapon breaks mid-fight
61	Allies abandon you
62	Fighting former friend
63	Berserk rage uncontrolled
64	Fighting to capture alive
65	Honor forbids certain tactics
66	Fight to prove worth

Social Conflicts

D66	Social Challenge
11	Insulted publicly at feast
12	Romantic rival appears
13	Accused of theft
14	Family embarrasses you
15	Political alliance crumbling
16	Caught in lie
21	Must choose between loyalties
22	Inappropriate love interest
23	Genealogy disputed
24	Inheritance contested
25	Religious conversion pressure
26	Forced marriage proposed
31	Secret revealed publicly
32	Patron demands impossible
33	Rival spreads rumors
34	Guest overstays welcome
35	Debt called in
36	Oath conflicts with desire
41	Children disgrace family
42	Wife/husband's infidelity
43	Shunned by Thing
44	Cultural misunderstanding
45	Generosity expected, can't afford
46	Must support unpopular cause
51	Friend becomes enemy

D66	Social Challenge
52	Enemy seeks reconciliation
53	Reputation prevents romance
54	Too famous to have privacy
55	Clan expects too much
56	Younger generation disrespects
61	Social climbing backfires
62	Old shame resurfaces
63	Must humble self publicly
64	Gift-giving escalates dangerously
65	Peer pressure toward dishonor
66	Love vs. duty choice

Seidr Magic & Rituals

D66	Magical Event
11	Prophecy clearly spoken
12	Curse laid on enemy
13	Blessing for voyage
14	Weather-working attempted
15	Speaking with dead
16	Seeing into future
21	Shapeshifting ritual
22	Protection ward placed
23	Love spell cast
24	Illness cured magically
25	Enemy's hamingja drained
26	Landvættir summoned

D66	Magical Event
31	Runes carved for luck
32	Battle-magic preparation
33	Death-curse pronounced
34	Fertility blessing
35	Sight beyond sight granted
36	Memory wiped by magic
41	Seidr trance goes wrong
42	Spirit possession
43	Magical compulsion placed
44	Truth-telling forced
45	Illusion woven
46	Time manipulation
51	Raising the dead
52	Binding enemy's weapon-luck
53	Finding lost item magically
54	Healing serious wound
55	Sending message via dreams
56	Seeing through another's eyes
61	Breaking curse
62	Transferring luck
63	Calling storm
64	Making self invisible
65	Berserker rage induced
66	Opening gate to Otherworld

INSPIRATION TABLES

Verbs

Verbs	1	2	3	4	5	6
1	Raid	Avenge	Swear	Betray	Sail	Honor
2	Curse	Prophesy	Slay	Flee	Challenge	Forge
3	Mourn	Plunder	Exile	Witness	Claim	Deceive
4	Sacrifice	Wrestle	Navigate	Outlast	Boast	Reconcile
5	Hunt	Carve	Burn	Negotiate	Endure	Remember
6	Strike	Bind	Discover	Abandon	Judge	Inherit

Adjectives

Adjectives	1	2	3	4	5	6
1	Blood-stained	Oath-bound	Cursed	Honorable	Icy	Storm-wracked
2	Ancient	Vengeful	Bitter	Sundered	Fearless	Treacherous
3	Frostbitten	Wandering	Condemned	Proud	Forsaken	Ruthless

Adjectives	1	2	3	4	5	6
4	Sacred	Ill-fated	Restless	Unyielding	Shadowed	Hunger-driven
5	Far-traveled	Kin-sworn	Battle-scarred	Silent	Haunted	Desperate
6	Nameless	Twice-born	Disgraced	Faithful	Grim	Sea-hardened

Nouns

Nouns	1	2	3	4	5	6
1	Feud	Oath	Kinsman	Blade	Saga	Wound
2	Völva	Jarl	Ship	Rune	Winter	Ghost
3	Reputation	Blood	Shore	Hall	Exile	Omen
4	Draugr	Thing	Mound	Betrayal	Skald	Fate
5	Vengeance	Sacrifice	Seidr	Holmgang	Storm	Hoard
6	Ancestor	Prophecy	Warrior	By-name	Longship	Spirit

APPENDIX: INSPIRATIONAL MEDIA

Television

- *Vikings* (History Channel) - Saga-style drama, though historically loose
- *The Last Kingdom* (Netflix) - England during Viking invasions
- *Norsemen* (Netflix) - Dark comedy set in Viking Age Norway

Film

- *The Northman* (2022) - Revenge saga with historical authenticity
- *Valhalla Rising* (2009) - Surreal, violent, atmospheric
- *Pathfinder* (2007) - Viking raid on North America
- *The 13th Warrior* (1999) - Beowulf adaptation with Vikings

Books

- **Icelandic Sagas**: *Njal's Saga*, *Egil's Saga*, *Grettir's Saga*, *Laxdæla Saga*
- **Bernard Cornwell**: *The Saxon Stories* (Vikings vs. Saxons)
- **Snorri Sturluson**: *Prose Edda* (mythology), *Heimskringla* (kings' sagas)
- **Frans G. Bengtsson**: *The Long Ships* (adventure novel)
- **Michael Ridpath**: *Fire and Ice* series (modern crime set in Iceland with saga themes)

Manga & Anime

- *Vinland Saga* (Makoto Yukimura) - Historically grounded Viking epic

Games

- *God of War* (2018) - Norse mythology, father-son dynamics
- *Assassin's Creed Valhalla* (2020) - Viking settlement in England
- *Crusader Kings III* (Paradox) - Medieval grand strategy including Vikings
- *Banner Saga* trilogy - Turn-based tactics with Norse inspiration

Music

- Wardruna - Norwegian folk using historical instruments
- Heilung - Amplified history/experimental
- Danheim - Dark Viking atmospheric

APPENDIX: GLOSSARY OF OLD NORSE TERMS

Althing: The general assembly in Iceland, held annually at Thingvellir. World's oldest parliament.

Berserkr (pl. **Berserkir**): "Bear-shirt" warriors who fought in trance-like fury, believed to shapeshift.

Blót: Pagan sacrifice to the gods, typically of livestock, ale, or (rarely) humans.

Danelaw: Parts of England under Viking law and settlement (9th-11th centuries).

Drengskapr: Honorable conduct—courage, generosity, honesty, loyalty.

Draugr: Undead corpse, typically guarding burial mounds and treasure.

Fylgja: Personal spirit/fetch appearing as animal omen, often before death.

Goði (pl. **Goðar**): Chieftain-priest, leader of local assembly and religious rites.

Hamingja: Family spiritual luck inherited and built through honorable deeds.

Hamramr: Shapeshifter; one who walks in animal form while body sleeps.

Haugbúi: Intelligent barrow-dweller; undead who can speak and bargain.

Hersir: Military commander, war-leader serving a jarl.

Holmgang: Ritual duel fought on island or marked ground to settle disputes.

Huldufólk: "Hidden folk"—elves/spirits living in rocks and hills.

Jarl: Noble lord, chieftain ruling territory.

Jötunn (pl. **Jötnar**): Giant; ancient enemies of gods and humans.

Landvættir: Land spirits protecting specific places.

Níðingr: Ultimate insult—a nothing, coward, one without honor. Being declared *níðingr* = outlawry.

Níðhöggr: Great serpent gnawing at world-tree roots in mythology.

Nidstöng: Curse pole raised to proclaim someone *níðingr* and call spirits against them.

Nøkk: Water spirit luring people to drown.

Ófriðr: Blood feud; state of vendetta between families.

Örlög (or **Örlog**): Personal fate shaped by past deeds.

Ragnarök: End of the world in Norse mythology (not the focus of this game).

Seidr: Magic practice, especially by völvas, involving trance and prophecy.

Skald: Poet, saga-teller, keeper of reputation and memory.

Thing (or **Þing**): Local assembly for law-speaking, judgment, and political business.

Thrall: Slave; lowest social class.

Víkingr: Raider; one who goes "a-viking" (raiding/trading by sea).

Völva: Seeress, shamaness practicing seidr magic and prophecy.

Weregild: "Man-price"—legal compensation payment for killing, measured in silver.

Wyrd: Anglo-Saxon equivalent of örlög; fate woven by past deeds.

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